2026-07-04 22:19:23 You Asked

this r code returns 2 string, how can I get the second one only in the chain. I do not want to assign to a temp variable

"""

lists[1] |>
  html_elements("h5 a") |>
  # html_attr("title") |>
  html_attr("href")"""

ChatGPT gpt-5-5

Good question—this is a classic **pipe + vector subsetting** situation in R.

Your pipeline returns a character vector of length 2, and you want the **second element only**, without breaking the chain.

✅ Clean solution (recommended)

Just subset at the end:

```r
lists[1] |>
  html_elements("h5 a") |>
  html_attr("href") |>
  (\(x) x[2])()
```

👉 This uses an **anonymous function** inside the pipe.

🧠 Why this is needed

The base pipe `|>` does **not** support `.[2]` like `%>%` does.

So this ❌ won't work:

```r
... |> .[2]
```

✅ Alternative (shorter, still clean)

```r
lists[1] |>
  html_elements("h5 a") |>
  html_attr("href") |>
  (\(.) .[2])()
```

Same idea, just shorter notation.

✅ If you're okay using magrittr (`%>%`)

Then it becomes simpler:

```r
lists[1] %>%
  html_elements("h5 a") %>%
  html_attr("href") %>%
  .[2]
```

✅ Another option (index earlier)

If you only need the second `<a>` :

```r
lists[1] |>
  html_elements("h5 a") |>
  (\(x) x[2])() |>
  html_attr("href")
```

👉 More efficient (you subset before extracting attributes)

💡 Best practice

If performance matters:

> ✅ Subset **as early as possible** in the chain

🚀 Final recommendation

Use this:

```r
lists[1] |>
  html_elements("h5 a") |>
  (\(x) x[2])() |>
  html_attr("href")
```

✔ cleaner
✔ faster
✔ avoids unnecessary extraction

If you want, I can show you how to:

- Or 👍